ODOO 17

Complete User Guide

For All Departments | April 2026 | English

This guide walks every Odoo user — from a brand-new employee to a power user — through the most common daily tasks across Sales, Purchase, Inventory, Accounting, HR, CRM, and the core platform. Each chapter uses numbered step-by-step instructions with tips, notes, and keyboard shortcuts to help you work faster.

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Chapter 1

Getting Started & Navigation

1.1 Logging In

1 **Open your browser**

Navigate to your Odoo URL, e.g. **https://mycompany.odoo.com**

2 **Enter credentials**

Type your **Email** and **Password**, then click **Log in**

3 **Two-factor authentication**

If 2FA is enabled, enter the 6-digit code from your authenticator app

■ **Tip:** Bookmark the login URL and use your browser's password manager to save time every day.

1.2 The Home Screen & App Menu

After login you land on the **Home Screen** which shows all applications your user has access to. Click any app icon to open it.

- **Top bar** — Search, messaging bell, activities, user menu
- **Main menu** — Module-specific sub-menus (e.g. Sales → Orders → Quotations)
- **Breadcrumb** — Shows your current location and lets you navigate back
- **Action menu (■)** — Duplicate, archive, export the current record

1.3 Views — List, Kanban, Form, Calendar, Pivot

View	Icon	Best For
List	■	Scanning many records at once, bulk actions

View	Icon	Best For
Kanban	■	Pipeline stages, drag-and-drop workflow
Form	■	Viewing or editing a single record in full detail
Calendar	■	Scheduling — meetings, leave, delivery dates
Pivot	■	Cross-tab analysis and totals
Graph	■	Bar, line, pie charts from live data
Activity	■	See all scheduled activities across records
Map	■	Geo-location of contacts or deliveries

1.4 Search, Filters & Group By

The **Search Bar** at the top of every list/kanban view is very powerful:

- Type a keyword and press Enter to search across multiple fields
- Click the ■ **arrow** inside the search bar to open Filters and Group By options
- **Filters** narrow records (e.g. 'My Activities', 'Today', 'Draft')
- **Group By** stacks records under categories (e.g. by Salesperson, by Stage)
- **Favourites** — save your filter + group combination as a personal favourite

■ **Tip:** Combine a Filter with a Group By for powerful instant reports — e.g. filter 'This Month' + group by 'Salesperson' shows each rep's monthly performance.

1.5 Keyboard Shortcuts

Action	Shortcut / Path
Open global search	`Alt + Shift + S`
Save current record	`Alt + S (or click Save button)`
Discard changes	`Escape`

Action	Shortcut / Path
New record	`Click New button or Alt + N`
Open a relational field popup	`Open the dropdown and press Tab`
Navigate between fields	`Tab / Shift+Tab`
Print / Download report	`Action menu → Print`

Chapter 2

Sales — Quotations & Orders

2.1 Creating a Quotation

1 **Go to Sales**

Open the **Sales** app → **Orders** → **Quotations**

2 **New**

Click the **New** button to open a blank quotation form

3 **Set the Customer**

Type the customer name; Odoo auto-fills address and pricelist

4 **Add Products**

In the **Order Lines** tab, click **Add a product**; set quantity and unit price

5 **Apply a Pricelist**

Change the **Pricelist** field to auto-calculate customer-specific pricing

6 **Add Discount**

Enable discounts in Sales Settings; a Discount % column appears on lines

7 **Send by Email**

Click **Send by Email** to preview and dispatch the PDF quotation to the customer

8 **Confirm**

Once accepted, click **Confirm** — the quotation becomes a **Sales Order**

■ **Tip:** Use **Quotation Templates** (Sales → Configuration → Quotation Templates) to pre-fill recurring products and terms, cutting quote creation time significantly.

2.2 Sales Order Statuses

Status	Meaning	Next Action
Quotation	Draft — not sent to customer	Send by Email or Confirm
Quotation Sent	Email dispatched; awaiting reply	Confirm or cancel
Sales Order	Confirmed; triggers delivery & invoice	Create Invoice
Locked	Posted invoice exists; order is locked	No edits allowed
Cancelled	Order cancelled	Can reset to draft

2.3 Creating an Invoice from a Sales Order

1 **Open the Sales Order**

Navigate to the confirmed sales order

2 **Click Create Invoice**

Top button — choose invoicing policy: ordered qty or delivered qty

3 **Review Invoice**

Check lines, taxes, and due date on the draft invoice

4 **Confirm (Post)**

Click **Confirm** to post the invoice; it gets an official number

5 **Register Payment**

Click **Register Payment**, select journal (bank/cash), and save

■ **Note:** The green smart button at the top of the sales order shows how many invoices have been created for it.

2.4 Delivery & Shipping

When a sales order is confirmed, Odoo automatically creates a **delivery order** in the Inventory module:

- Click the **Delivery** smart button on the sales order to open it
- Click **Check Availability** to reserve stock
- Set the **Done** quantity for each line (or click **Set Quantities**)
- Click **Validate** to record the shipment and reduce stock

> **Warning:** Validating a delivery cannot be easily undone. Create a **Return** from the delivery if goods come back.

Chapter 3

Purchase — RFQs & Purchase Orders

3.1 Creating a Request for Quotation (RFQ)

1 **Open Purchase App**

Purchase → Orders → Requests for Quotation

2 **New**

Click **New** to create a blank RFQ

3 **Select Vendor**

Choose the supplier; their lead time and currency auto-populate

4 **Add Products**

Click **Add a product** in the lines; set quantity and expected date

5 **Send RFQ**

Click **Send by Email** to notify the vendor

6 **Receive Vendor Offer**

When the vendor responds, update price and confirm with **Confirm Order**

■ **Tip:** Use **Purchase Agreements** (blanket orders) for vendors you buy from regularly to lock in pricing for a period.

3.2 Receiving Goods

Once the vendor ships goods, record the receipt:

- Open the Purchase Order → click the **Receipt** smart button
- Verify quantities; adjust **Done** column if partial delivery
- Click **Validate** — stock is updated and a vendor bill can now be created

3.3 Vendor Bill

- On the Purchase Order, click **Create Bill**
- Match the bill lines to the receipt (3-way matching)
- Set the **Bill Date** and **Due Date**
- Click **Confirm** to post — it moves to Accounts Payable
- Pay via **Register Payment** or batch payment from Accounting

> **Note:** Enable **Purchase Order Lock** in settings so a PO cannot be modified after goods are received.

Chapter 4

Inventory — Receipts, Deliveries & Stock

4.1 Inventory Overview

The Inventory dashboard shows cards for each **Operation Type** (Receipts, Deliveries, Internal Transfers, Returns). Each card displays the number of ready and waiting operations.

- **Receipts** — Incoming goods from vendors
- **Delivery Orders** — Outgoing goods to customers
- **Internal Transfers** — Moving stock between locations/warehouses
- **Manufacturing** — Finished goods production (if Manufacturing app installed)

4.2 Receiving Stock

1 **Open Receipt**

Inventory → Operations → Receipts → open the relevant receipt

2 **Scan or Enter Quantities**

Fill in **Done** column; scan barcodes if using the scanner feature

3 **Set Lot/Serial (if tracked)**

For products tracked by lot or serial number, enter or scan the number

4 **Validate**

Click **Validate** — stock moves into your warehouse location

■ **Tip:** Use the **Odoo mobile app** with barcode scanning for faster warehouse operations.

4.3 Stock Adjustment (Physical Inventory)

Correct stock discrepancies after a physical count:

- Inventory → Operations → Physical Inventory

- Click **New** or open an existing scheduled date
- Add products and enter the **Counted Quantity**
- Click **Apply All** — Odoo creates adjustment moves for the differences

4.4 Product Traceability

For lot/serial-tracked products, view the full history:

- Open the product → click **Traceability** smart button
- Or: from any stock move, click the lot/serial number link
- The traceability report shows every movement from receipt to delivery

> ■ **Note:** Traceability is essential for recalls. Always enable lot tracking for food, pharma, or regulated products.

Chapter 5

Accounting — Invoices & Payments

5.1 Creating a Customer Invoice

1 **Navigate**

Accounting → Customers → Invoices → New

2 **Select Customer**

Choose the customer; currency and payment terms auto-fill

3 **Add Lines**

Click **Add a line**; select the product or account, quantity, and price

4 **Check Taxes**

Verify the tax column; Odoo applies default taxes from the product

5 **Set Due Date**

Enter the invoice date and the due date (or select a payment term)

6 **Confirm**

Click **Confirm** — the invoice is posted with a sequential number

7 **Send**

Click **Send & Print** to email the PDF invoice to the customer

8 **Register Payment**

When paid, click **Register Payment** and select the bank journal

■ **Tip:** Use **Recurring Invoices** (set a Recurring Plan on the invoice) for monthly subscription billing — Odoo auto-generates the next invoice.

5.2 Invoice Status Flow

Status	Description
Draft	Created but not posted; can be freely edited
Posted	Confirmed with official number; journal entry created
In Payment	Payment registered but bank not yet reconciled
Paid	Fully paid and reconciled — green banner
Overdue	Past due date and not fully paid — red banner
Cancelled	Reset to draft and deleted (number remains for audit)

5.3 Bank Reconciliation

After importing your bank statement, reconcile transactions to keep your books accurate:

- Accounting → Accounting → Bank → click **Reconcile Items**
- Odoo suggests matches based on amount and date — click **Match** to accept
- For unmatched items, create a new payment or write-off directly in the reconciliation view
- When the statement is fully reconciled, click **Close**

5.4 Key Accounting Reports

Report	Location	Purpose
Profit & Loss	Accounting → Reporting → P&L;	Revenue vs expenses by period
Balance Sheet	Accounting → Reporting → Balance Sheet	Assets, liabilities, equity snapshot
Cash Flow	Accounting → Reporting → Cash Flow	Actual cash in/out
Aged Receivable	Accounting → Reporting → Aged Receivable	Overdue customer balances

Report	Location	Purpose
Aged Payable	Accounting → Reporting → Aged Payable	Overdue vendor balances
Tax Report	Accounting → Reporting → Tax Report	VAT / GST filing data

Chapter 6

CRM — Leads & Opportunities

6.1 CRM Pipeline Overview

The CRM pipeline is a **Kanban board** where each column represents a stage in your sales process. Cards represent opportunities that can be dragged between stages.

- Default stages: New → Qualified → Proposition → Won
- Stages can be customised per sales team (CRM → Configuration → Stages)
- Each card shows the customer, expected revenue, and probability
- Red/orange dots indicate overdue activities

6.2 Creating a Lead / Opportunity

1 **New**

CRM → Pipeline → click **New** or drag a card into 'New' column

2 **Fill Details**

Enter Contact Name, Company, Phone, Email, and Expected Revenue

3 **Set Stage & Probability**

Drag the card to the correct stage; adjust probability %

4 **Schedule Activity**

Click the clock icon on the card to schedule a call, email, or meeting

5 **Log a Note**

Open the record → Chatter → **Log note** to keep internal context

6 **Convert to Opportunity**

If leads are enabled, click **Convert to Opportunity** to merge duplicates

6.3 Winning & Losing Opportunities

Mark as Won ■

Click **Won** button on the form or drag to 'Won' column. Enter the closing reason. Triggers a sales order if configured.

Mark as Lost ■

Click **Lost** button, select a **Lost Reason** (configure these at CRM → Configuration → Lost Reasons), and add a note.

■ **Tip:** Review lost reasons monthly in CRM → Reporting → Lost Reasons to identify patterns and improve your pitch.

Chapter 7

Human Resources — Employees & Leave

7.1 Employee Profile

Each employee has a rich profile with multiple tabs:

Tab	Key Information
General Info	Job position, department, manager, coach, work location, work email & phone
Work Information	Timezone, working schedule, planned hours
Private Information	Date of birth, marital status, emergency contact, visa details
HR Settings	Employee type, related user account, PIN (for attendance kiosk)
Resume	Work experience, skills, certifications

7.2 Requesting Leave (Employee View)

1 **Open Time Off app**

Click the **Time Off** app or go via Employees → Time Off

2 **New Allocation / Leave**

Click **New Time Off** to request leave

3 **Select Leave Type**

Choose Annual Leave, Sick Leave, etc.

4 **Set Dates**

Enter the start and end date; the duration calculates automatically

5 **Description**

Add a note if required, then click **Save**

6 **Approval**

Your manager receives an activity; they approve or refuse the request

■ **Note:** Your leave balance is shown on the Time Off dashboard. Allocations must be created (by HR) before you can request certain leave types.

7.3 Manager — Approving Leave

- Go to **Time Off** → **Managers** → **All Time Off**
- Filter by **To Approve** to see pending requests
- Click a request → review dates → click **Approve** or **Refuse**
- The employee receives an email notification automatically

7.4 Attendance & Payroll Overview

- **Attendance:** Employees check in/out from the kiosk (PIN or badge), mobile app, or the Attendance menu
- **Overtime:** Odoo compares planned hours (from working schedule) vs actual check-in hours
- **Payslip:** Payroll → Payslips → New; select employee and period; run computation → confirm
- **Batch Payslip:** Payroll → Payslip Batches for processing the whole company at once

■ **Warning:** Payroll structures (salary rules) must be configured by an HR/Payroll manager before individual payslips can be computed.

Chapter 8

Contacts & Communication

8.1 Managing Contacts

The **Contacts** app is the central address book shared across Sales, Purchase, Accounting, and HR.

- **Contact Type** — Individual or Company; individuals can be linked to a company
- **Tags** — Label contacts (e.g. 'VIP', 'Partner', 'Prospect') for easy filtering
- **Smart Buttons** — On each contact you see their sales, invoices, meetings at a glance
- **Merge** — Select duplicates in list view → Action → Merge to combine them

8.2 Chatter — Messages, Notes & Activities

The **Chatter** is the communication panel at the bottom of every record:

Feature	How to Use
Send Message	Sends an email to followers; they can reply directly to the record
Log Note	Internal note — only Odoo users can see it; not sent externally
Schedule Activity	Create a to-do (call, email, meeting) linked to this record
Followers	Add colleagues to subscribe them to updates on this record
Attachment	Drag and drop files; they are stored in the filestore

8.3 Discuss — Internal Messaging

The **Discuss** app (speech bubble icon in the top bar) provides Slack-like real-time messaging:

- **Direct Messages** — One-to-one or group chat with colleagues
- **Channels** — Topic-based rooms (e.g. #sales-team, #announcements)
- **Video / Audio Call** — Built-in calling within a DM or channel

- **Emoji reactions** — React to messages with emojis

> **Tip:** Pin important messages in a channel (right-click → Pin) so the team can quickly find key information.

Chapter 9

Reporting & Dashboards

9.1 Built-in Reports by Module

Module	Key Reports
Sales	Sales Analysis, Team Performance, Expected Revenue
Purchase	Purchase Analysis, Vendor Analysis
Inventory	Stock Valuation, Forecasted Stock, Expiry Dates
Accounting	P&L;, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow, Tax Report, Aged Balances
CRM	Pipeline Analysis, Win/Loss, Activity Reports
HR	Leave Analysis, Attendance, Payroll Summary

9.2 Pivot View — Ad Hoc Analysis

The **Pivot** view lets you build custom cross-tab reports without writing SQL:

- Switch to Pivot view using the grid icon in the top-right
- Click **+** in the row or column header to add a grouping dimension
- Use the **Measures** dropdown to change the metric (e.g. Count, Sum of Revenue)
- Click **Insert in Spreadsheet** to send the pivot to an Odoo Spreadsheet for further analysis
- Export to Excel via **Download XLSX**

9.3 Dashboards

Create a personal dashboard to monitor your KPIs at a glance:

1

Open Dashboards

Main menu → Dashboards (or the Dashboard icon on the home screen)

2 **Add a Graph**

Go to any report in Graph view → click **Insert in Dashboard**

3 **Arrange Widgets**

Drag and resize the cards on your dashboard

4 **Share**

Click **Share** to make a dashboard visible to a specific group

■ **Note:** Dashboards are personal by default. Use Spreadsheets for collaborative, shared reporting with management.

Chapter 10

Tips, Shortcuts & Best Practices

10.1 Top Keyboard Shortcuts

Action	Shortcut / Path
Open any app quickly	`Click home (■) → type app name`
Global search across all records	`Click the ■ in top bar → type keyword`
Create a new record anywhere	`Click New or press the New button (Alt+N in some browsers)`
Quick save	`Click the Save button or navigate away (auto-save)`
Open Discuss / Inbox	`Click the speech bubble icon in top bar`
Bulk select in list view	`Check the top checkbox to select all visible records`
Export selected records	`Select records → Action → Export`
Duplicate a record	`Action menu (■) → Duplicate`
Archive a record	`Action menu (■) → Archive`
Toggle developer mode	`URL → add ?debug=1 or Settings → Developer Tools`

10.2 Productivity Tips

- **Use Tags everywhere** — Tags on contacts, leads, products, and tickets help you filter and report instantly
- **Set Activities daily** — Start each day by checking your **Activity** view; it's your to-do list built into Odoo

- **Favourite your searches** — After setting up a filter, save it as a Favourite so you never have to rebuild it
- **Use Odoo mobile app** — Approve leaves, confirm quotations, and scan barcodes from your phone
- **Email alias per model** — Each project, team, or helpdesk can have its own email that auto-creates records
- **Paste images in Chatter** — Ctrl+V pastes a screenshot directly into a message for fast visual communication
- **Multi-tab workflow** — Open Odoo in multiple browser tabs to work across modules simultaneously

10.3 Common Mistakes to Avoid

Mistake	Correct Practice
Editing a posted invoice directly	Reset to draft first; or issue a credit note for corrections
Deleting records instead of archiving	Archive keeps the history intact; delete is permanent
Ignoring the Chatter	Always log context in the chatter — it's the audit trail for every record
Using the same product for all sales lines	Proper products give accurate reporting, inventory, and account mapping
Skipping activities	Activities ensure nothing falls through the cracks; schedule the next action before closing

10.4 Getting Help

- **In-app documentation** — Click the **?** icon (top-right) for context-sensitive help
- **Odoo Learn** — https://www.odoo.com/slides for free video courses
- **Odoo Community Forum** — https://www.odoo.com/forum for Q&A
- **Your system admin** — For configuration changes, new users, or module installs

You're ready to use Odoo! Start with the module most relevant to your role, explore the chatter on every record, and remember — every screen has a search bar and a Group By option that turns it into a live report.